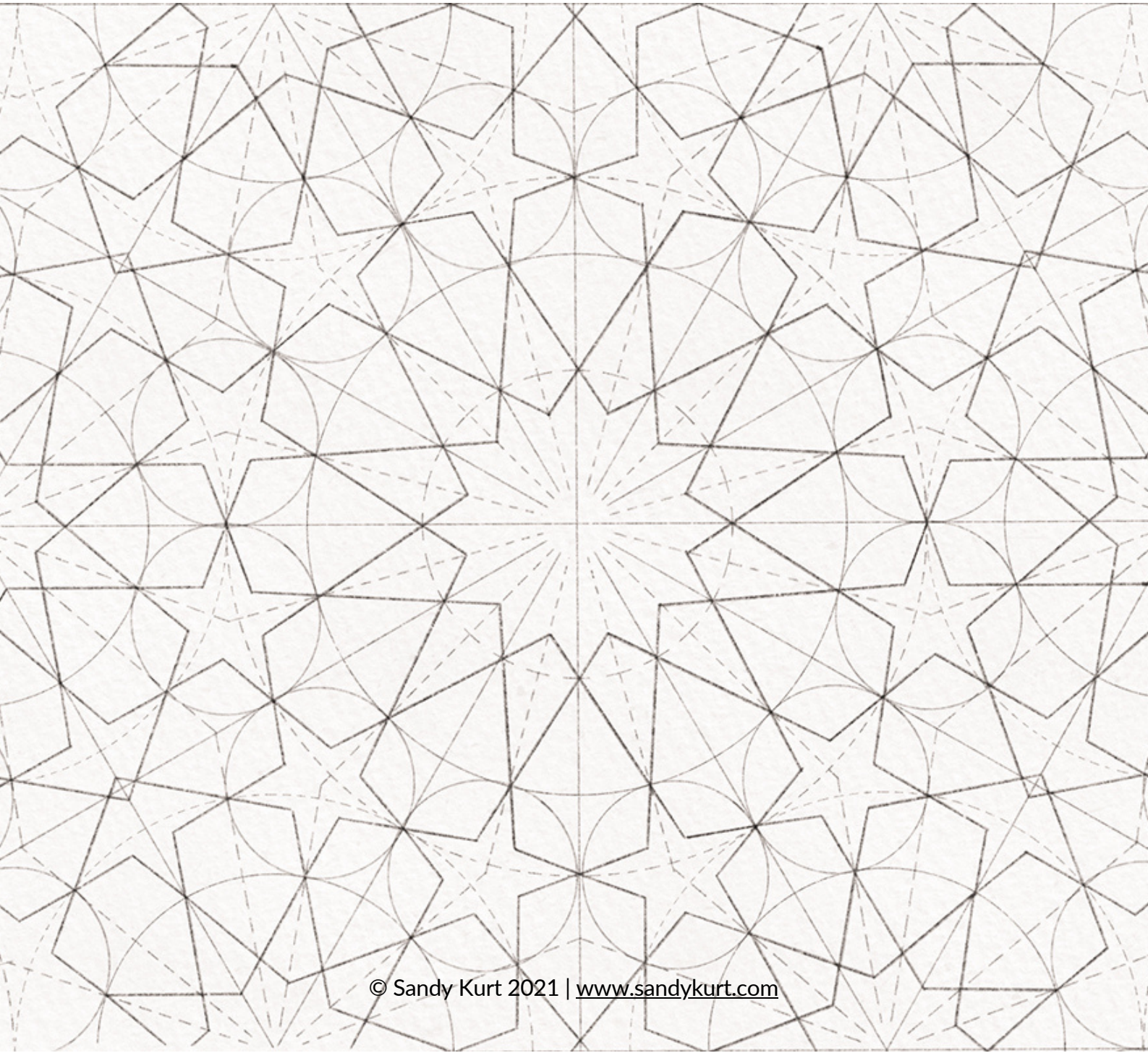
The ultimate guide

GET STARTED WITH ISLAMIC GEOMETRIC PATTERNS

Everything you need to get started in one place



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INTRODUCTION

It's my goal to help you overcome the hurdles and overwhelm that comes with drawing Islamic geometry!

I bet you have come across an Islamic geometric pattern on Instagram or Pinterest and you have been captured by the beauty of this art. Or that you have been following me for quite some time but you have been too shy to send me a message.
And now you are here, wondering how to get started because, my goodness, everyone seems to be rocking with all those crazy constructions and you don't even know how to handle a compass.

Well, here I am to the rescue.

I've crafted this freebie with so much information that you will start to question "is this even real"?

Yes, hun, IT IS.
But let's talk no more and see exactly what you need to get started.

In the following pages, you'll find:

- Supplies list
- Books and websites
- List of artists to follow
- List of free tutorials
- Online courses and classes
- In-person courses and workshops

Hey, I'm Sandy Kurt

I'm an artist, self-taught designer, and educator who is hell-bent on teaching everyone how to get started with Islamic geometry.

I was born during the Balkan war and raised in Italy, with nothing more than some pencils, cheap watercolors and passion, I'm proud to inspire people to leave their comfort zone and learn new ways to express their artistic self.

SUPPLIES LIST

I think this is the most important point of this freebie.
Islamic geometry is different from other art forms where you grab what you have in your house and just create. Unless you have a compass from school days left forgotten in a drawer, you will have to buy one to start drawing.
And this leads me to another point: **you can't even imagine how many different types of compass exist!**

We all have different budgets and expectations so, before listing the tools and supplies that I recommend, I want you to read some blog posts I wrote about that topic.
This will help you make your own conscious choice without the need for anyone's help.

On **this** page, I've listed both the blog posts and the supplies that I use with a direct link to Amazon for each item.

I've divided the list into 2 categories and 4 subcategories.
The two categories are "Drawing" and "Painting" and each category is divided into "Beginners" and "Advanced".

I know that not everyone wants to be an Islamic geometric artist or wants to spend money on expensive tools but before making any decision please read this post

3 REASONS TO INVEST IN HIGH-QUALITY TOOLS

If you live in a country where high-quality tools are not available I get it.
Otherwise, please don't buy cheap supplies unless

- you just want to try if Islamic geometry is for you and then decide what to do
- you already know that you don't want to do this regularly

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BOOKS AND WEBSITES

Who doesn't like a good book?
I love books and I have quite a few about Islamic geometry.
But if you think that you can learn how to draw Islamic geometric patterns only from books, well this might not be the best decision.

Only a few have tutorials in them and some are even wrong.
When you are just starting out it's very difficult to understand that something is not correct.
This is why I've listed all the books I recommend **here**

In this list, you will find a flip-through of each book and a direct link to Amazon.

But that is not all. On the same page, you will find free downloadeble books, and links to websites and Facebook groups with amazing information about Islamic geometric patterns.

ARTISTS TO FOLLOW

I know it's hard to believe but what I know today is thanks to Instagram.
Besides all the books and websites and tutorials, the thing that helped me grow the most was IG.
If you know my background (you can read about how I got started **here**) you also know that **what helped me the most was trying to figure out the construction of the patterns on my own.**

When someone shared the construction of any pattern I would save it and then analyze it.
This is why I'm able to analyse complex patterns that nobody teaches.

But I'm not here to brag (maybe just a little bit HA).
So here are some artists that share interesting stuff that you may want to follow:

• MYSELF of course	website	Instagram	
• Ameet Hindocha aka Ambigraph	website	Instagram	
• Samira Mian	website	Instagram	YouTube
• Jeea Mirza	website	Instagram	
• Mohamad Aljanabi	website	Instagram	Youtube
• Margi Lake	website	Instagram	
• Rajen Astho		Instagram	Facebook
• Manuel Martinez Vela		Instagram	Youtube
• Richard Henry	website	Instagram	
• Adam Williamson	website	Instagram	
• Serap Ekizler Sönmez	website	Instagram	
• Alan Adams	website		
• Arabezier		Instagram	YouTube
• Reinout Engel aka Geomicon		Instagram	
• Ghazaleh Khayat	website	Instagram	
• Craft Draft Fes	website	Instagram	
• Global Centre of Islamic Art	website	Instagram	YouTube

Check their feed, their blog, the resource page on their websites....EVERYTHING.

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FREE TUTORIALS

Now, let's talk about FREE (oh yes, you've read it right) tutorials.

I highly recommend following the Drawing Islamic Geometric Designs.
Not only was it created by Alan Adams which is an amazing teacher BUT....(drumroll please)...
Check the "File" section in the group and you will find a ton of pdf tutorials available for free.

Samira Mian is another great source of tutorials in video form.
Her YouTube Channel has dozens of easy-to-follow tutorials perfect for beginners.

Note that many artists (including myself) offer free tutorials and are very approachable and of help.
By the way, you can check my tutorials **here**.

Other free tutorials can be found:

- Ambigraph — Website
- Mohamad Aljanabi — Youtube
- Rajen Astho — Facebook
- Manuel Martinez Vela — Youtube
- Arabezier — Youtube
- Ghazaleh Khayat — Website

Besides construction tutorials, I also have some juicy free stuff like:

- How to be accurate — video tutorial
- How to use a compass — video tutorial
- How to transfer a design — video tutorial
- How to weave — video tutorial
- How to fix a painting mistake — video tutorial
- Different types of compass — pdf guide
- Mini coloring book — e-book
- Choosing the perfect colour palette — resource guide

→ Big Tip!
We all want to share our passion with others no matter what. So if you follow someone's tutorial or you find inspiration in someone's work, give them credit on social media when posting your artwork. At the end of the day, that's what pushes us to share more.

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ONLINE COURSES AND CLASSES

The free tutorials only scratch the surface of the Islamic geometric patterns.
They help you to learn how to use a compass, divide a circle into equal parts and get the sense of proportion and symmetry.
Sooner or later you will crave more information so here is a list of artists/schools that offer online courses (pre-recorded) and classes (live).

Sandy Kurt	Online courses
Samira Mian	Online courses and classes
Craft Draft Fes	Online courses
Istanbul Design Center	Online classes
Art of Islamic Pattern	Online courses and classes
School of Traditional Arts	Online classes
Global Centre of Islamic Art	Online courses and classes

Other artists offer online classes every once in a while (for example Ameet, Alan and Rajen) so you'd better check their website/Instagram to get the info.

Online courses/classes are amazing because they help thousands of people learn Islamic geometry no matter where they are in the world.

Pre-recorded classes are amazing because you can go at your own pace and learn when you are comfortable to do so while live online classes are very helpful if you have questions and you need more assistance.

IN-PERSON COURSES AND WORKSHOPS

If you prefer real-life classes and you are lucky enough to live nearby one of the following schools/artists then the following list is for you.

As per the online courses, other artists do workshops every once in a while so you'd better follow them to get the info.

The Prince's Foundation: School of Traditional Arts
Icherisheher Centre for Traditional Arts
Jameel House of Traditional Arts in Cairo
Jeddah Centre for Traditional Arts
The VM Centre for Traditional Art in Karachi
Istanbul Design Center
Sacred Art of Geometry
Art of Islamic Pattern
Samira Mian

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NOW WHAT?

Whether you are feeling super excited or overwhelmed, take a deep breath.
There is no rush to do it all now.
This guide was made to keep all things in one place and you have lifetime access to it.
Keep practising and you will get better and better :) I promise.

One year from now you will wish you had started today!

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